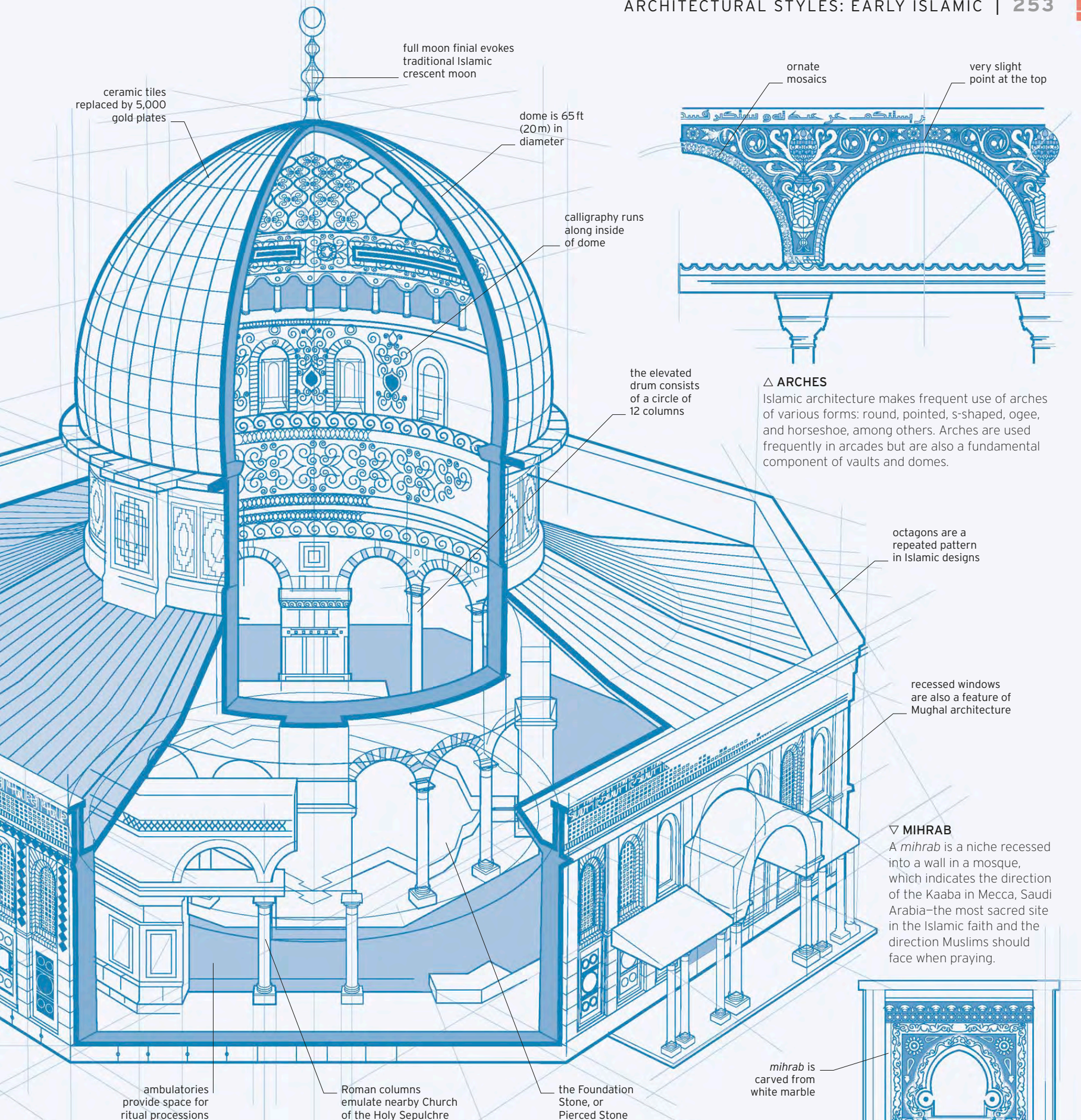




△ ARCHES

Islamic architecture makes frequent use of arches of various forms: round, pointed, s-shaped, ogee, and horseshoe, among others. Arches are used frequently in arcades but are also a fundamental component of vaults and domes.

▽ MIHRAB

A *mihrab* is a niche recessed into a wall in a mosque, which indicates the direction of the Kaaba in Mecca, Saudi Arabia—the most sacred site in the Islamic faith and the direction Muslims should face when praying.

The **176 lb (80 kg) of gold** used to plate the Dome of the Rock cost King Hussein of Jordan **\$8.2 million** in 1998